W. Jordan Charles

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INSTRUCTIONAL DESIGN | LEARNING EXPERIENCE DESIGN | LEARNING TECHNOLOGY

Instructional designer who takes learning programs from analysis through delivery: needs analysis to find what is actually broken, evidence-based design to fix it, and the platform work to get it in front of learners. Psychology research background; M.Ed. from the University of Utah.

EXPERIENCE

Instructional Designer February 2026 - Present
WeYouth (501(c)(3) nonprofit), North Salt Lake, UT

- Ran LMS market research against the organization's constraints and delivered the platform recommendation the nonprofit adopted and runs on today
- Implemented SME-authored curriculum into the LMS as enrollable self-paced courses with module architecture, self-assessments, and evaluation surveys
- Built separate learner tracks supporting Mental Performance Connection Coaching for young people ages 12-24
- Collaborate with founders, a licensed clinician, and coaching staff as subject matter experts on restructuring curriculum for self-paced online delivery
- Serve as the technical support function for the platform and its administrators

Instructional Design Intern May 2025 - July 2025
Chartway Credit Union (Financial Wellness team), South Jordan, UT

- Conducted a mixed-methods needs analysis for the FiCEP certification program: five semi-structured interviews and a survey returning 21 responses
- Applied thematic analysis to identify limited protected study time as the top barrier to certification (23 mentions)
- Applied the ADDIE framework and adult learning theory to deliver evidence-based curriculum recommendations
- Recommended WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility standards for the curriculum
- Chartway implemented the redesigned program and reported improved exam results (figures withheld to protect employee privacy)

Learning Technology Specialist (Contract) March 2023 - August 2023
National Association of Certified Valuators and Analysts (NACVA), via Robert Half, Sandy, UT

- Turned 50+ recorded webinars into on-demand continuing-education courses in Camtasia, published as SCORM packages with Articulate Presenter
- Wrote Python and Selenium scripts that set up each course in the learning platform and online store, automating about 80 hand steps per course
- Wrote a converter that imported each exam's questions from Word instead of retyping them

Help Desk Specialist January 2021 - May 2024
All Season Control Cover, Salt Lake City, UT

- Diagnosed user-reported problems and implemented fixes, translating technical detail into plain guidance

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant August 2018 - December 2018
Florida State University

- Supported development of educational software for stealth assessment in children's learning

Research Associate January 2017 - April 2017
Research & Business Development Center, Rexburg, ID

- Designed a pilot study, administered a survey to over one thousand participants, and presented findings to a city committee

Undergraduate Researcher April 2013 - July 2015
BYU-Idaho Psychology Department

- Conducted literature reviews, generated testable hypotheses, gathered and analyzed data, and presented findings at conferences

EDUCATION

Master of Education (M.Ed.), Instructional Design & Educational Technology: University of Utah, August 2023 - May 2025. GPA 3.9. 30 credit hours across five semesters.

Bachelor of Science, Psychology: Brigham Young University - Idaho, 2012 - 2018. Certificate in Programming.

SELECTED PROJECTS

AI & Law, S.J. Quinney College of Law: Ten-module graduate course for Master of Legal Studies students, built in Canvas by a three-person capstone team

FiCEP Curriculum Needs Analysis: Mixed-methods needs analysis for a credit union's certification-preparation program, with evidence-based redesign recommendations

Articulate Storyline 360 course: 278-slide branching scenario build with consequential decision points

Teaching the Waltz: Self-paced Canvas course for a physical skill, co-designed with a classmate, assessed by learner-submitted video and validated by small-group formative evaluation

SKILLS

Authoring: Articulate Storyline 360, Rise, Camtasia, Adobe Creative Suite

Platforms: LearnWorlds (selection, implementation, administration), Canvas LMS

Methodology: ADDIE, SAM, Backward design, Formative and summative evaluation, Cognitive walkthrough

Research: Experimental design, Survey design, Semi-structured interviewing, Thematic analysis, Statistical analysis (SPSS)

Theory: Cognitive load theory, Andragogy, Mayer's multimedia principles, Universal Design for Learning, Bloom's taxonomy

Technical: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, HTML/CSS

PRESENTATIONS

Charles, W.J. (2014, Dec). Does Money Inequality Affect Empathy and Compassion? Poster session, Research & Creative Works Conference, Rexburg, ID.

North, A.J., & Charles, W.J. (2014, Apr). The Effects of PowerPoint on Student-Teacher Connection. Poster session, Rocky Mountain Psychological Association, Salt Lake City, UT.

HONORS

Research & Creative Works Conference: Finalist and 1st Place; Finalist and 3rd Place in a separate year